

Accountant Practice – AI Based End-to-End Business Process Automation Platform

Objective:

Remove the repetitive administrative work performed by Account Practice employees, from the first customer enquiry until the accountant completes the work and the customer receives confirmation.

We are not building:

- An accounting system.
- A bookkeeping application.
- A tax calculation engine.
- A replacement for HMRC or Companies House.
- An alternative to the accountant's professional judgement.
- We ARE building an intelligent operational platform that sits around the existing accounting and practice-management software.

It will manage customers, employees, documents, payments, queries, reminders, deadlines, escalations and task allocation.

Think of it as a digital operations employee working 24/7 for every Account Practice branch.

1. Understanding the Account Practice business

First, we need to understand the business model.

Account Practice Accountants operates through a UK network of locally managed accountancy practices serving individuals, sole traders, partnerships, landlords and limited companies. Its publicly listed services cover business and personal tax, accounts, VAT, payroll, bookkeeping and advisory services.

British Franchise Association+2

The platform must therefore support different customer types and service journeys.

A. Customer categories

Customer category	Typical requirements
Individual employees	Self Assessment, tax returns
Sole traders	Annual accounts, Self Assessment
Limited companies	Annual accounts, Corporation Tax
Partnerships	Partnership accounts and tax returns
Landlords	Property income and tax returns
Contractors	Self Assessment, CIS
Employers	Payroll, PAYE, pensions
Start-ups	Company formation, registration, accounts
Existing businesses	VAT, bookkeeping, payroll, accounts
Directors	Personal tax, dividends, company accounts

B. Services the platform should cover

Business services

- Business accounts
- Corporation Tax
- VAT returns
- Bookkeeping
- Payroll & HR
- Tax planning
- R&D tax credits
- Cash-flow management
- Business plans
- Making Tax Digital
- Tax investigations
- Business advisory

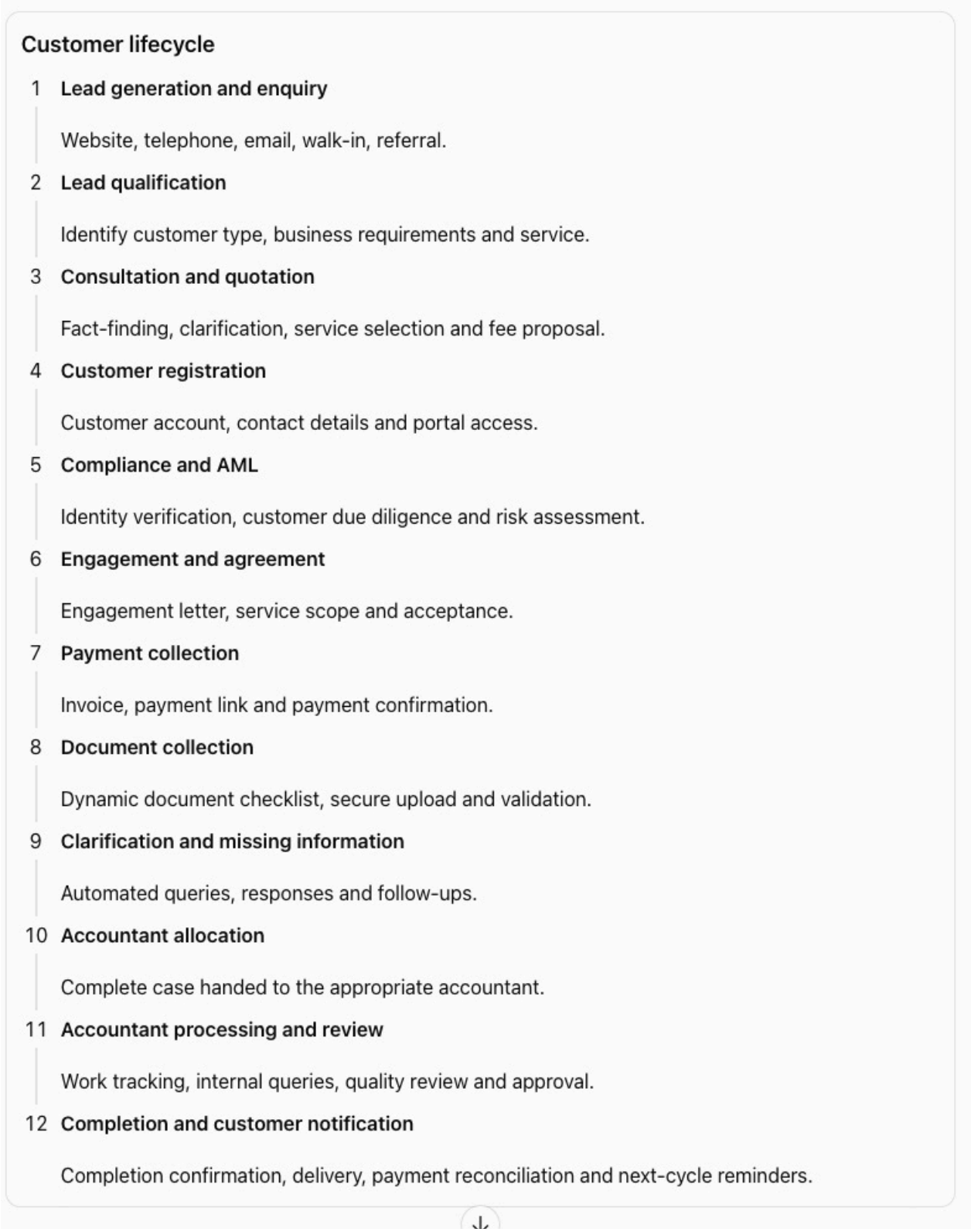
Personal services

- Self Assessment
- Capital Gains Tax
- Property income tax
- Personal tax planning
- Cryptocurrency tax
- Director tax returns
- Pension-related tax
- Employment tax

Important: Each service must have its own workflow, document checklist, payment rules, deadlines, queries and completion criteria. A Self Assessment customer should not receive the same onboarding journey as a limited company requiring annual accounts and Corporation Tax.

2. The complete business lifecycle

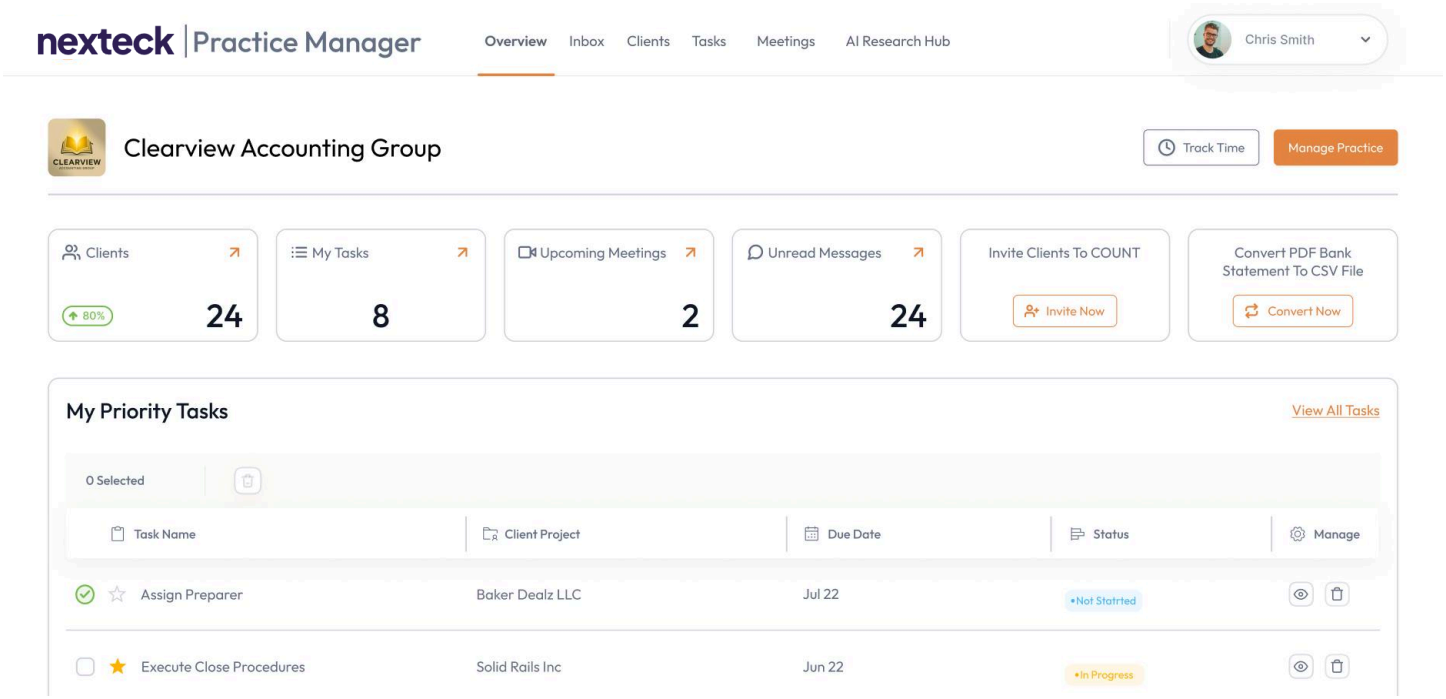
I recommend designing the platform around 12 connected stages.



The most important principle is that the system must know exactly where every customer stands and what needs to happen next.

Detailed step-by-step workflow

Stage 1 – Lead generation and enquiry management



Objective: Capture every potential customer and prevent leads from being missed.

Enquiry sources:

- Account Practice website.
- Local branch website.
- Google Business Profile.
- Telephone calls.
- Email enquiries.
- Walk-in customers.
- Existing customer referrals.
- Marketing campaigns.
- Social media.
- Automated process

1. A customer submits an enquiry.
2. System creates a unique Lead ID.
3. System identifies the enquiry source.
4. AI reads the enquiry and identifies the likely service.
5. System identifies whether the person is a new or existing customer.
6. The lead is assigned to the appropriate branch.
7. Customer receives an acknowledgement email/SMS.
8. A sales follow-up task is created.
9. If no employee contacts the customer within the configured SLA, the branch manager receives an alert.
10. Example acknowledgement:

Steps after receiving the enquiry

a. "for auto Thank you for contacting Account Practice. We have received your enquiry regarding your tax. Are you interested to continue or you want to speak with our expert”

b. On clicking on Interested to continue based on the selected services, it provides the details like Applicable to whome, what all the documents required, how many working days it will take, what will the cost. Allow them to select Continue or if you have any further question ask. system will auto provide the required clarification.

AI capability: Lead classification, enquiry summarisation, customer intent identification and suggested service allocation.

Employee involvement: Only where a consultation, qualification or professional judgement is needed.

Stage 2 – Lead qualification and sales automation

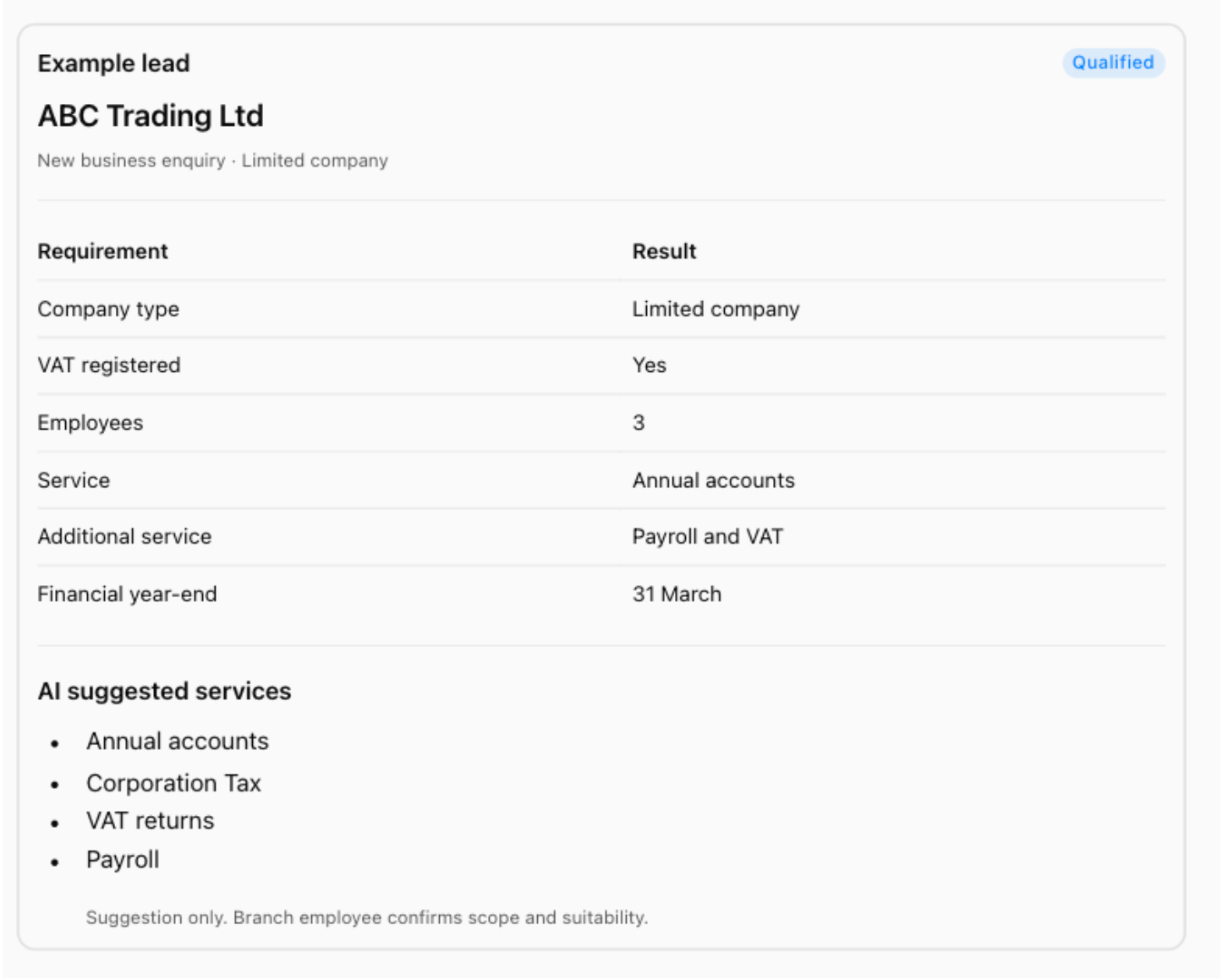
Objective: Understand what the customer needs before preparing the quotation.

The platform sends the customer a short digital questionnaire link.

Example questions:

- Are you an individual or a business?
- Do you operate as a sole trader or limited company?
- Are you a new or existing business?
- Which services do you require?
- What is your financial year-end?
- Are you currently registered for VAT?
- Do you have an existing accountant?
- What is the reason for changing accountants?
- What is your expected service start date?
- AI analyses the answers and recommends a potential service category.

Example:



Automation:

- Create lead profile.
- Recommend relevant services.
- Assign sales representative.
- Schedule consultation.
- Send appointment confirmation.
- Send appointment reminders.
- Record consultation outcome.
- Create quotation task.

Stage 3 – Consultation, proposal and quotation

- This is an important commercial stage.

The accountant or authorised employee discusses the customer's requirements.

The platform should provide:

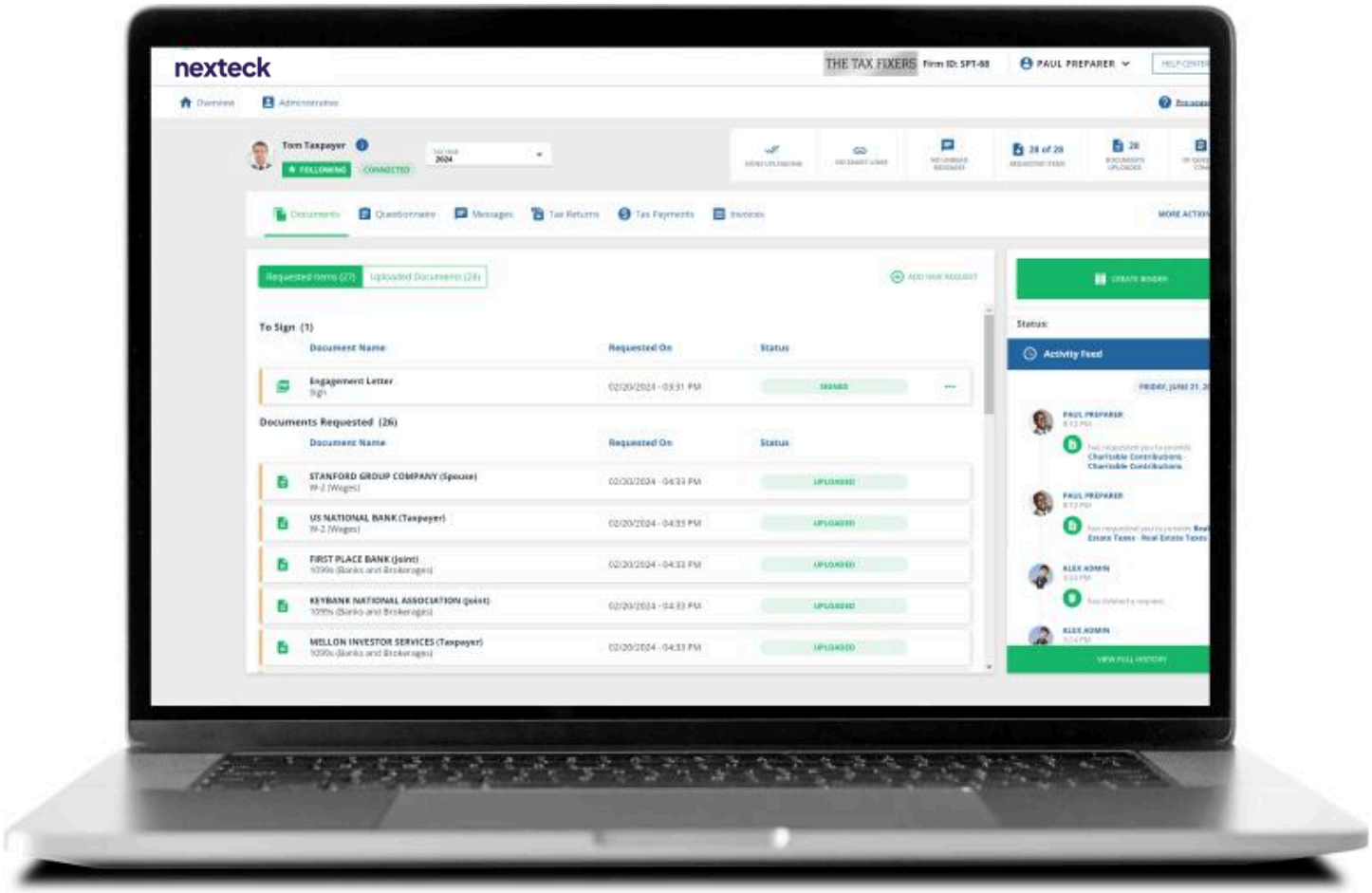
1. Customer profile.
2. Enquiry summary.
3. Previous communications.
4. Customer questionnaire.
5. Suggested services.
6. Consultation notes.
7. Pricing template.
8. Proposal generator.
9. After consultation:

- Employee selects the required services.
- System generates a quotation.
- Customer receives a proposal.
- Customer can accept or reject.
- If accepted, the system moves the customer to onboarding.
- If no response, automated follow-ups are triggered.
- Suggested quotation statuses:

Draft → Sent → Viewed → Accepted → Rejected → Expired

The system should support fixed fees, recurring fees, one-off charges and additional work quotations.

Stage 4 – Customer registration and portal creation



Once a quotation is accepted:

1. Create a Customer ID.
2. Create a customer portal.
3. Generate a secure invitation link.
4. Customer sets password or uses secure authentication.
5. Customer confirms contact details.
6. Customer confirms residential/business address.
7. Customer confirms relevant business details.
8. Customer receives onboarding instructions.
9. For an existing customer, the system should recognise their Customer ID and avoid creating a duplicate account.

Important: One customer can have multiple businesses and multiple services. For example, a director may have personal Self Assessment and two limited companies.

The data model must support this relationship.

Stage 5 – AML, identity verification and compliance

Regulatory control

This stage must not be treated as an ordinary document upload checklist.

The platform should support the firm's AML process, but the authorised compliance person must retain responsibility for decisions and escalations.

HMRC requires customer due diligence when establishing relevant business relationships. Requirements include identifying and verifying customers, assessing the relationship's purpose and nature, understanding beneficial ownership where relevant, and maintaining appropriate records. The extent of checks depends on risk.

Automated workflow:

1. Customer receives identity verification request.
2. Customer uploads or provides required information.
3. Platform connects to an approved identity verification provider.
4. Verification result is received.
5. Customer risk assessment is initiated.
6. Relevant company and beneficial ownership information is collected.
7. System identifies potential missing information.
8. Higher-risk cases are routed to the compliance officer.
9. Compliance officer records approval or requests additional checks.
10. System records the evidence and decision.

Possible statuses:

Status	Meaning
Not started	Verification not initiated
Pending	Customer action required
In progress	Checks underway
Additional information	More evidence required
Manual review	Compliance officer intervention
Approved	Compliance approval recorded
Rejected	Relationship cannot proceed

Critical rule: AI must never independently approve AML clearance, dismiss suspicious activity or make the firm's statutory compliance decisions.

The system should also support ongoing CDD refreshes for existing customers when circumstances change.

Stage 6 – Engagement letter and customer agreement

After the appropriate compliance checks, the platform generates the engagement letter.

The document should include:

- Customer details.
- Service details.
- Scope of work.
- Exclusions.
- Responsibilities of customer.
- Responsibilities of Account Practice practice.
- Fees and payment terms.
- Expected completion dates.
- Data protection information.
- Engagement terms.

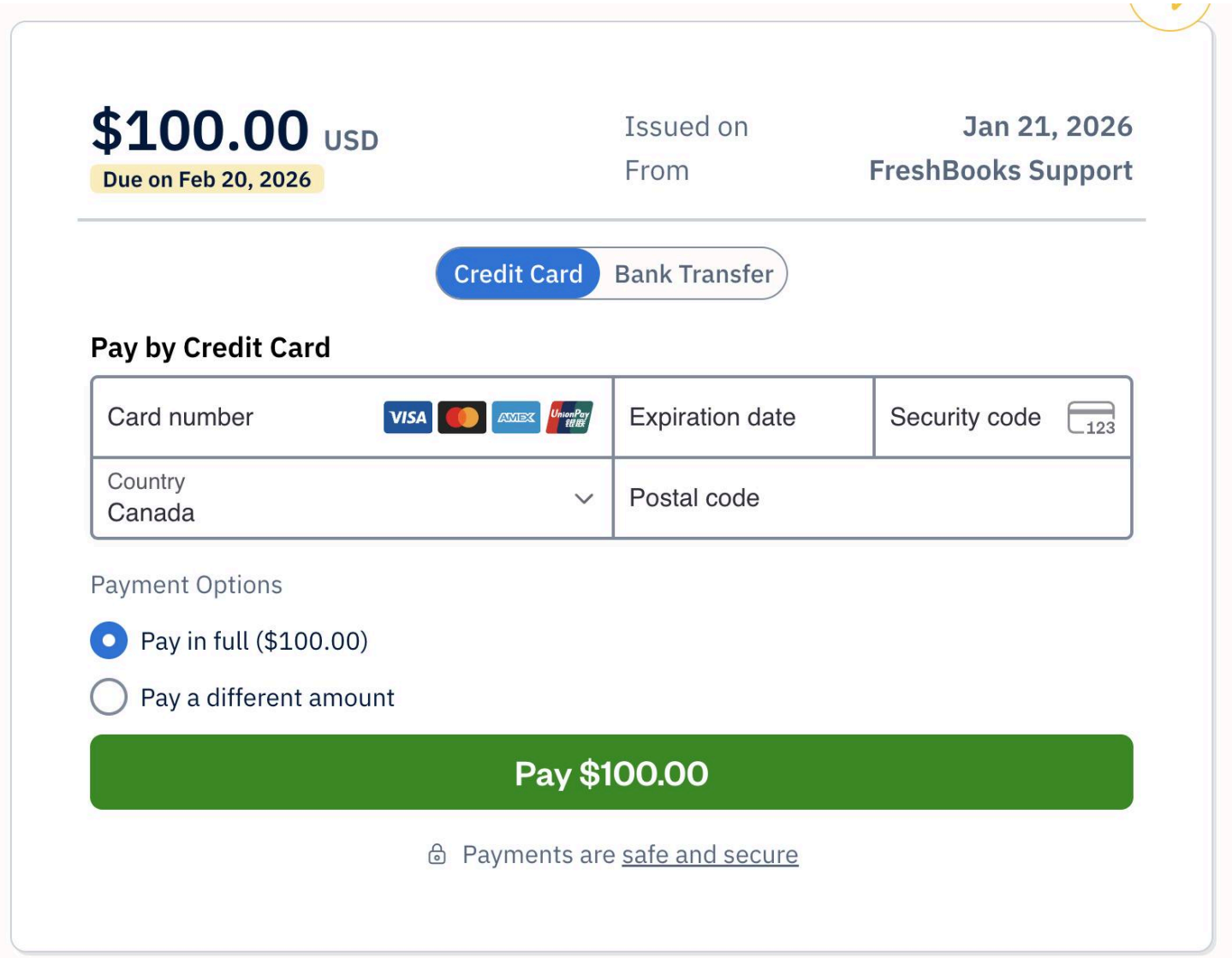
Automated process:

1. Generate engagement letter from approved template.
2. Send to customer.

3. Customer reviews.
4. Customer signs electronically.
5. Signed document is stored.
6. System updates engagement status.
7. Customer receives confirmation.

The templates and sequence must be configurable to match the firm's approved compliance policy.

Stage 7 – Invoice and payment collection



Once the commercial terms are agreed, the system generates the appropriate invoice or payment request.

Payment scenarios:

- Full upfront payment.
- Deposit followed by balance.
- Monthly recurring payment.
- Quarterly payment.

- One-off service payment.
- Credit terms for approved customers.
- Existing customer account billing.
- Payment automation:

1. Generate invoice.
2. Send invoice by email.
3. Provide secure payment link.
4. Customer pays.
5. Payment gateway sends webhook.
6. System updates payment status.
7. Payment receipt is generated.
8. Customer receives confirmation.
9. Accountant's work queue is updated when the case meets its release conditions.
10. Payment statuses:

Not invoiced → Invoice sent → Awaiting payment → Part paid → Paid → Overdue → Refunded

Important business rule: Payment is a configurable work-release condition, not a universal legal prerequisite for every accounting task. Some existing customers may work on credit or recurring billing arrangements. The platform must honour approved commercial terms and must not automatically block urgent statutory work where an authorised manager has approved an exception.

Stage 8 – Intelligent document collection

One of the highest-value modules

This is where we can remove a substantial amount of repetitive administrative work.

The platform should not send a generic upload link. It should generate a personalised document checklist based on:

- Customer type.
- Service selected.
- Accounting period.
- Previous customer information.
- Tax year.
- Business circumstances.
- Additional requirements identified by the accountant.
- Example: Self Assessment document checklist
- DocumentRequired
- P60If applicable
- P45If applicable
- P11DIf applicable
- Bank interest statementsIf applicable
- Dividend statementsIf applicable
- Rental income detailsIf applicable

- Property expensesIf applicable
- Pension contributionsIf applicable
- Gift Aid donationsIf applicable
- Previous tax returnIf required
- Other income evidenceIf applicable

Example: Limited company annual accounts

Document	Required
Business bank statements	Yes, as applicable
Sales invoices	As applicable
Purchase invoices	As applicable
Expense receipts	As applicable
Previous annual accounts	If needed
Previous Corporation Tax return	If needed
VAT returns	If registered
Payroll reports	If applicable
Director loan information	If applicable
Asset purchase information	If applicable
Stock information	If applicable
Loans and finance statements	If applicable

Example: VAT returns

- Sales records.
- Purchase records.
- VAT invoices.
- Credit notes.
- Import/export VAT evidence, if applicable.
- Previous VAT return, if needed.
- Relevant adjustments and supporting information.

- These are starting templates, not mandatory universal lists. The accountant must be able to add, remove or mark documents as not applicable.
- Document automation process

gettruss.io

1. Customer receives a document request.
2. Customer logs into the portal.
3. Customer sees a checklist.
4. Customer uploads a document against each requirement.
5. System records upload date and file owner.
6. AI classifies the document.
7. OCR extracts relevant information.
8. System checks file readability and basic completeness.
9. System flags possible duplicates.
10. System identifies missing or potentially incorrect files.
11. Customer receives a request for replacement or clarification if needed.
12. Once all required items are received, the case moves to document review.
13. Document status model
14. StatusDescription
15. RequiredNot uploaded
16. UploadedReceived
17. ProcessingAI/OCR processing
18. AcceptedInitial validation passed
19. RejectedUnreadable or incorrect
20. ClarificationAdditional information needed
21. Not applicableAuthorised employee exemption
22. VerifiedReviewed and accepted by authorised reviewer

Very important: An AI document classifier must not decide that a tax document is substantively correct merely because it recognises the file. The system should distinguish between technical validation, completeness checks and professional verification.

Stage 9 – Automated customer clarification and follow-up

This module is essential because employees in accountancy practices spend considerable time chasing customers for missing information and explaining what they need to provide.

The system should act as a first-line customer support assistant.

Example scenario

A customer uploads bank statements but misses the March statement.

The system identifies the missing period and sends:

Automated customer email

Subject: Additional document required – Your annual accounts

Dear ABC Trading,

Thank you for uploading your documents.

We have received your bank statements for April to February. However, the March statement is still outstanding.

Please upload the missing statement using your secure customer portal.

Once received, we can move your documents to the next stage.

Thank you,

Account Practice Team

Automatically triggered

Types of clarification

The platform should support:

1. Missing documents.
2. Unreadable documents.
3. Missing financial periods.
4. Incomplete customer information.
5. Unclear transactions.
6. Missing expense explanations.
7. Missing dividend information.
8. Missing director loan information.
9. Missing VAT information.
10. Other accountant-specific questions.
11. AI clarification assistant
12. Customer asks:

"Why do you need my bank statements?"

AI responds using an approved knowledge base:

"We need your business bank statements to help your accountant review business income and expenditure for the accounting period. Please upload statements covering the requested dates."

If the question requires tax advice or professional interpretation, AI creates a query for the accountant instead of guessing.

Query management

Every clarification must have:

- Unique query ID.
- Customer ID.
- Related service/job ID.
- Question.
- Requested information.
- Assigned employee, where necessary.
- Date raised.
- Response deadline.
- Customer response.
- Resolution status.
- Query statuses:

Open → Sent to customer → Customer responded → Under review → Resolved

If the customer replies by email or WhatsApp, the system should link the communication to the relevant case.

The objective is to eliminate employees manually composing repetitive emails and checking inboxes throughout the day.

Stage 10 – Automated reminders, escalation and telephone calls

Critical operational module

We should implement a multi-channel notification engine.

The system must understand the difference between:

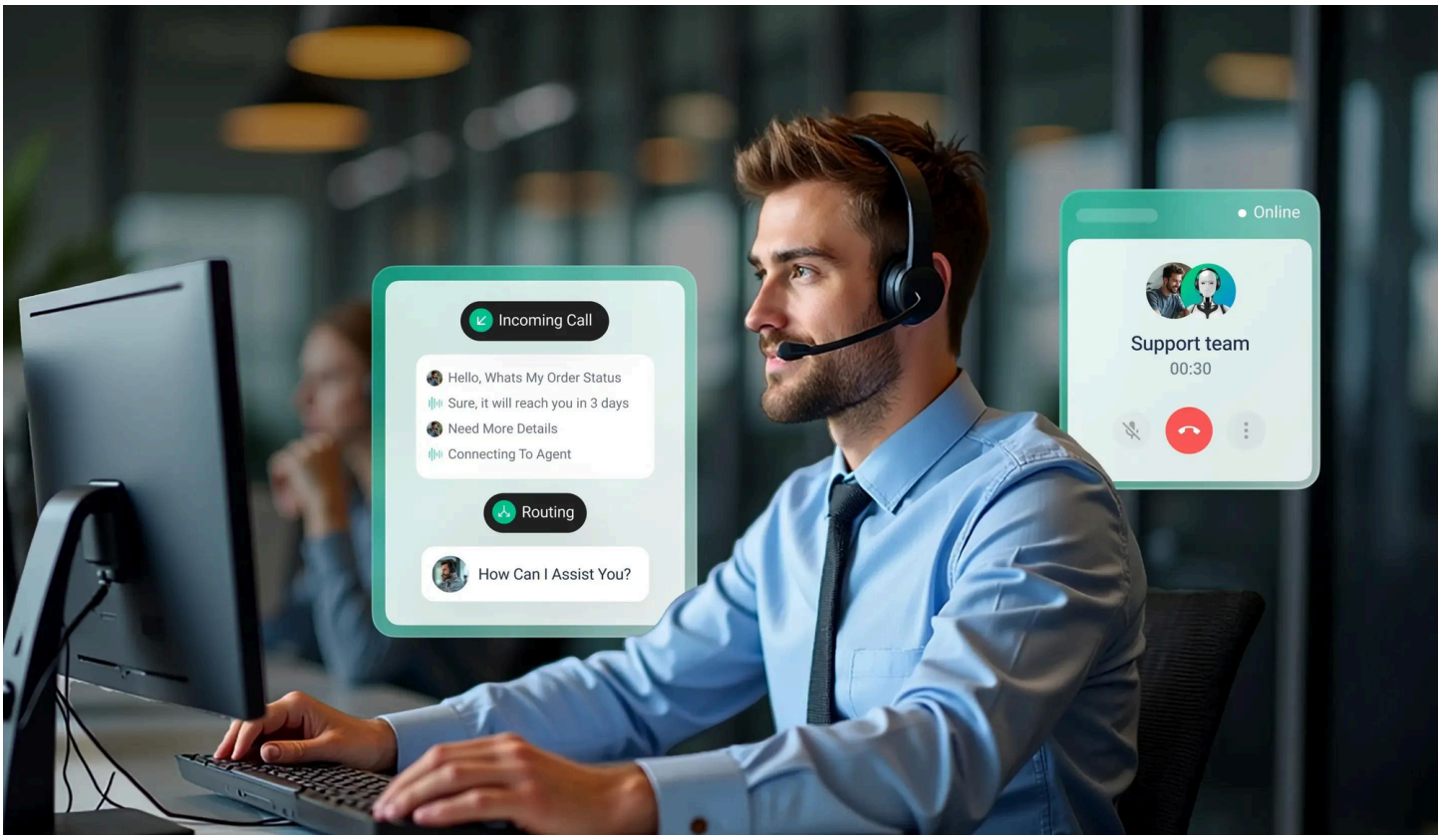
- Normal reminders.
- Overdue reminders.
- Critical statutory deadlines.
- Internal processing delays.
- Unresponsive customers.
- Urgent management escalations.
- Customer notification sequence
- Example: Customer has not uploaded the required documents.
- TriggerAction
- Day 0Initial document request
- Day 2Friendly email reminder
- Day 4Email and SMS reminder
- Day 6Second reminder with outstanding items
- Day 8Automated telephone call
- Day 10Escalation to branch employee
- Day 12Branch manager notification

These are configurable example timings, not fixed Account Practice policy.

Automated telephone call

This is one of the features I strongly recommend.

aigroup360.com



The system integrates with a voice AI provider.

Example call:

"Hello, this is an automated assistant calling on behalf of your Account Practice accountancy practice.

We are contacting you regarding your outstanding documents for your annual tax return.

Our records indicate that some documents are still missing.

Would you like us to send you a secure upload link by SMS?"

Possible responses:

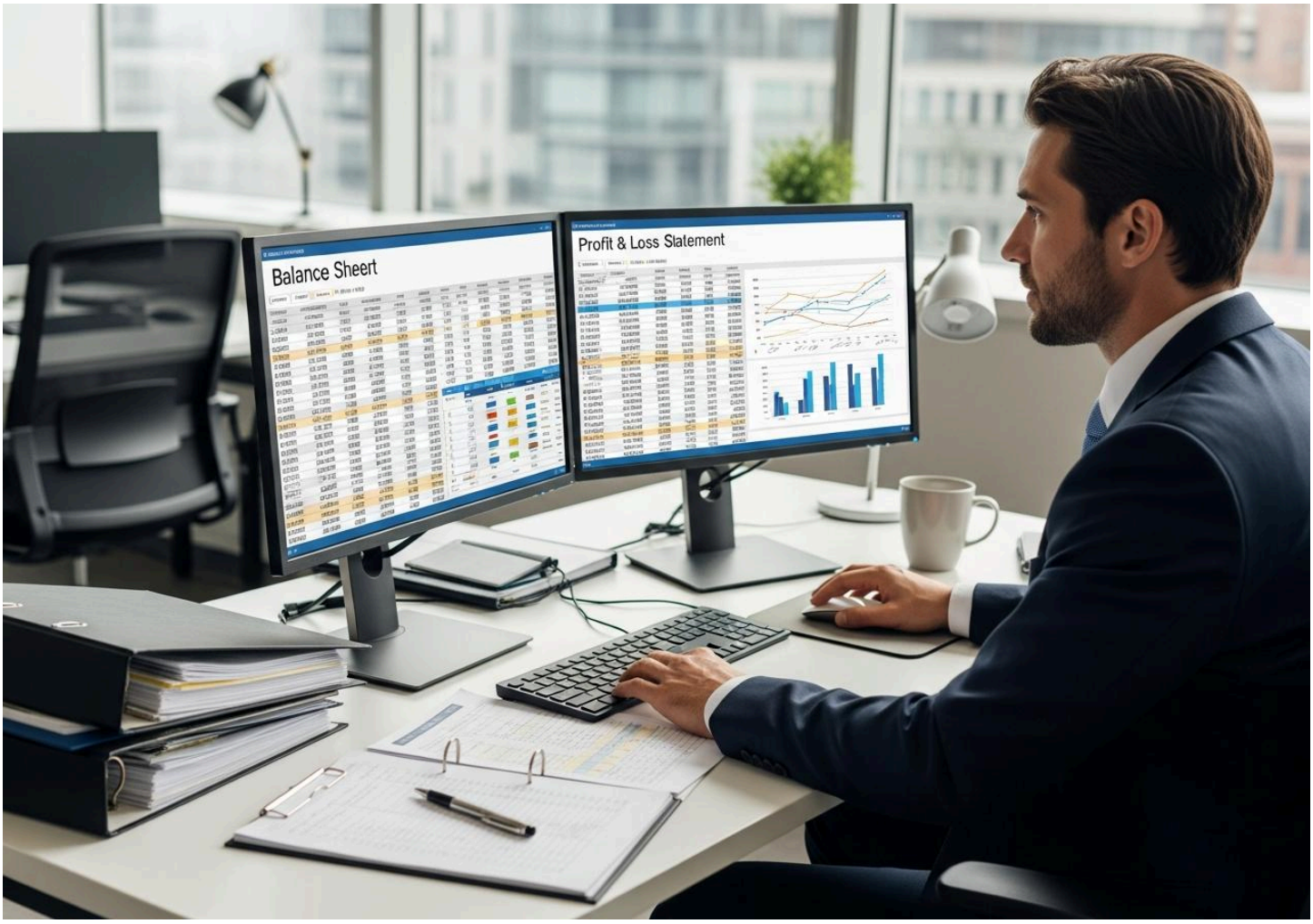
- Yes, send the link.
- I have already uploaded the documents.
- I need help understanding what is required.
- I would like to speak to my accountant.
- I need more time.
- The AI records the conversation and updates the case.
- Critical deadline escalation
- Suppose a customer's Corporation Tax return has an approaching filing deadline.

The system should:

1. Monitor the deadline recorded in the case.
2. Calculate the remaining working time using the firm's configured rules.
3. Check outstanding documents.
4. Check whether the accountant has started the work.
5. Identify any processing bottleneck.
6. Notify the customer if customer action is required.
7. Notify the assigned accountant.
8. Notify the branch manager if the case is at risk.
9. Initiate an approved voice call if the customer remains unresponsive.
10. Create an urgent intervention task if the deadline is at risk.
11. Important: The system should not wait until a deadline has actually failed. It should identify risk beforehand.

A telephone call should be triggered by an approved risk policy, not merely by an arbitrary number of reminders. Critical customer calls should also have appropriate human escalation and opt-out handling.

Stage 11 – Accountant task allocation and processing



This is where the system hands over a properly prepared case to the accountant.

The accountant should not receive a case containing scattered emails, incomplete information or unorganised attachments.

Work release conditions

A case becomes eligible for the accountant's processing queue when:

- Customer onboarding is completed.
- Required AML/compliance approval is recorded.
- Engagement terms have been accepted.
- Required documents have been received and passed the relevant intake checks.
- Required clarifications are resolved.
- Payment or an authorised credit/payment exception is recorded.
- The service scope is confirmed.
- Some controls are mandatory compliance controls; others are commercial or operational controls and must be configurable.
- Automated handover package
- The accountant receives:
- InformationDescription
- Customer profileName, contact and business details
- ServiceType of accounting work
- Accounting periodRelevant financial/tax period
- DocumentsAll relevant uploaded files
- Document checklistComplete status
- AMLCompliance status and evidence reference
- EngagementSigned agreement
- PaymentInvoice and payment status
- ClarificationsAll questions and answers
- DeadlinesInternal and statutory deadlines
- AI summaryConcise overview of the case

Accountant task workflow

The accountant's work should follow a controlled workflow:

Accountant work queue

1. Ready for allocation – case passes release checks.
2. Allocated – assigned to an accountant.
3. Accepted – accountant accepts responsibility.
4. In progress – accountant begins processing in the existing accounting system.
5. Internal clarification – accountant raises a query or requests additional evidence.
6. Customer action required – customer is notified automatically.
7. Processing resumed – required information received.
8. Ready for review – accountant completes preparation.
9. Quality review – reviewer checks and approves the work.
10. Ready for delivery – authorised completion is recorded.

Intelligent accountant allocation

The platform should allocate cases based on:

- Branch.
- Service type.
- Accountant skills.
- Current workload.
- Priority.
- Deadline.
- Existing customer relationship.
- Employee availability.
- For example, payroll cases should go to payroll-trained staff, while complex tax matters should be routed to appropriately qualified specialists.

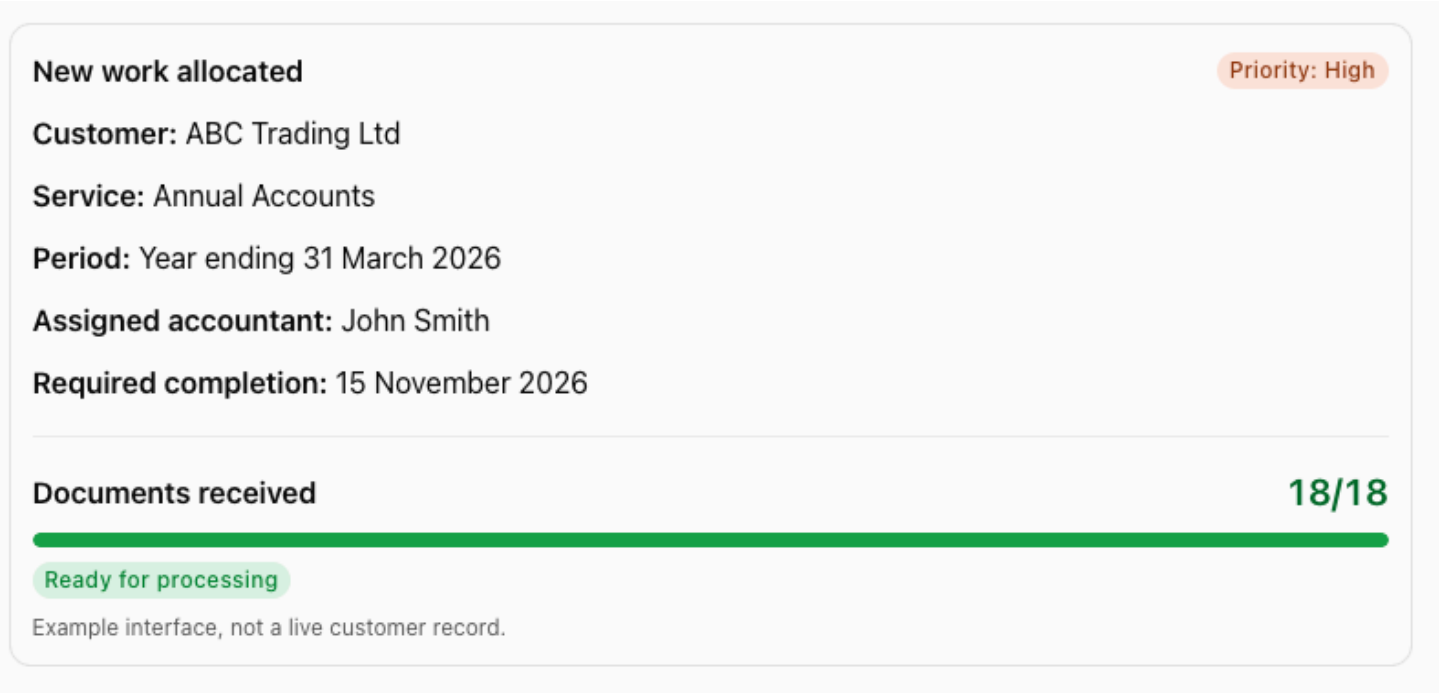
The manager must always be able to override allocation.

Accountant notifications

When a case is allocated, the accountant receives:

- Email notification.
- In-app notification.
- Dashboard task.
- Direct case link.
- Deadline information.

Example interface, not a live customer record.



Stage 12 – Completion, delivery and next-cycle automation

The system should not consider the work completed merely because the accountant changes a status.

We need a controlled completion process.

Completion workflow

1. Accountant finishes the work.
2. Accountant records completion.
3. Required review is completed.
4. Reviewer approves the work.
5. Filing/submission status is recorded where relevant.
6. Relevant deliverables are uploaded or linked.
7. Customer receives a completion email.
8. Customer is notified if any further action is required.
9. Case is closed.
10. Relevant records are archived according to retention policy.
11. Next service cycle is created or scheduled.
12. Customer satisfaction feedback is requested.

Example completion email: Service completion notification

Subject: Your annual accounts have been completed

Dear ABC Trading,

We are pleased to confirm that your annual accounts service has been completed.

Your accountant has finalised the work and the relevant completion details are available through your secure customer portal.

Thank you for choosing Account Practice.

Account Practice Team

The actual email must distinguish between accounts prepared, reviewed, approved, submitted and accepted by the relevant authority. These are different events.

For example, preparing a Corporation Tax return is not the same as submitting it to HMRC.

Recurring service automation

For existing customers:

- Automatically create the next accounting-period job.
- Reuse verified customer profile information.
- Identify changes in business circumstances.
- Refresh relevant compliance information.
- Generate the new document checklist.
- Send advance reminders.
- Track the next statutory deadline.
- Create the accountant's future workload.

Existing customer management – a separate journey

I would not force existing customers through the full new-customer onboarding process every time they request a service.

They should have a much shorter experience.

Existing customer journey

1. Customer logs into existing portal.
2. Selects the service or receives an automatically generated service request.
3. System retrieves existing customer and business details.
4. System checks whether any profile or AML refresh is due.
5. System generates only the new-period document checklist.
6. Customer uploads outstanding documents.
7. AI checks file classification, readability and completeness.
8. Customer receives clarification requests where required.
9. Invoice/payment terms are applied.
10. Case is released to the accountant.
11. Accountant completes and reviews the work.
12. Customer receives completion notification.
13. Next service cycle is automatically scheduled.

Example: Existing Self Assessment customer

Last year the customer submitted:

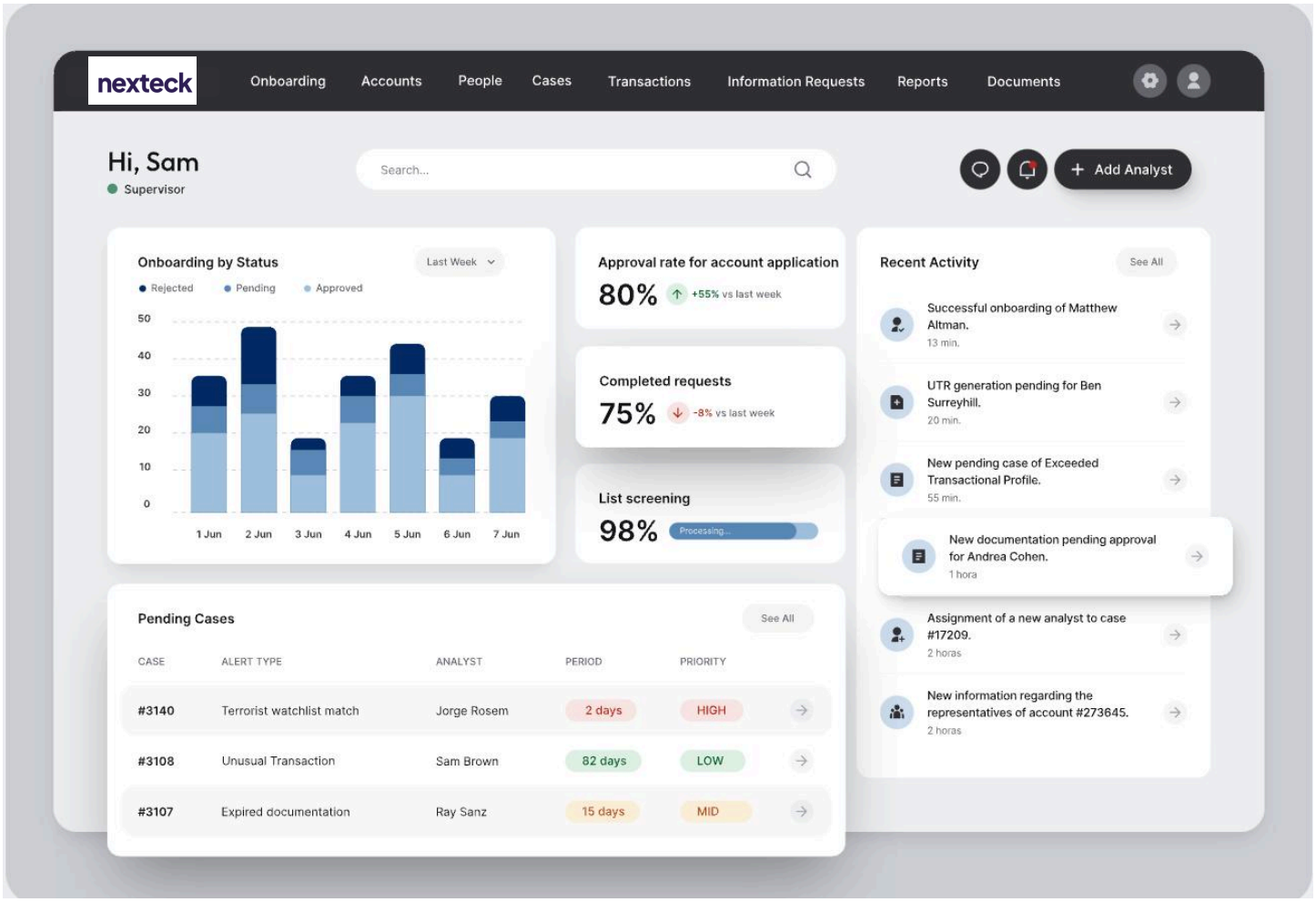
- P60.
- Bank interest statement.
- Rental income details.
- Property expense information.
- This year, the system should not blindly request all information again.

It should:

1. Reuse relevant profile details.
2. Check whether the customer still has rental income.
3. Ask whether employment circumstances changed.
4. Request the new P60, if applicable.
5. Request new-period rental income and expenses.
6. Identify new sources of income.
7. Request only documents relevant to the current return.
8. This is a significant opportunity to reduce customer frustration and unnecessary employee work.

The dashboard – what each employee should see : I recommend five main dashboards, each with a different purpose.

A. Branch manager dashboard



This should provide a complete picture of the branch.

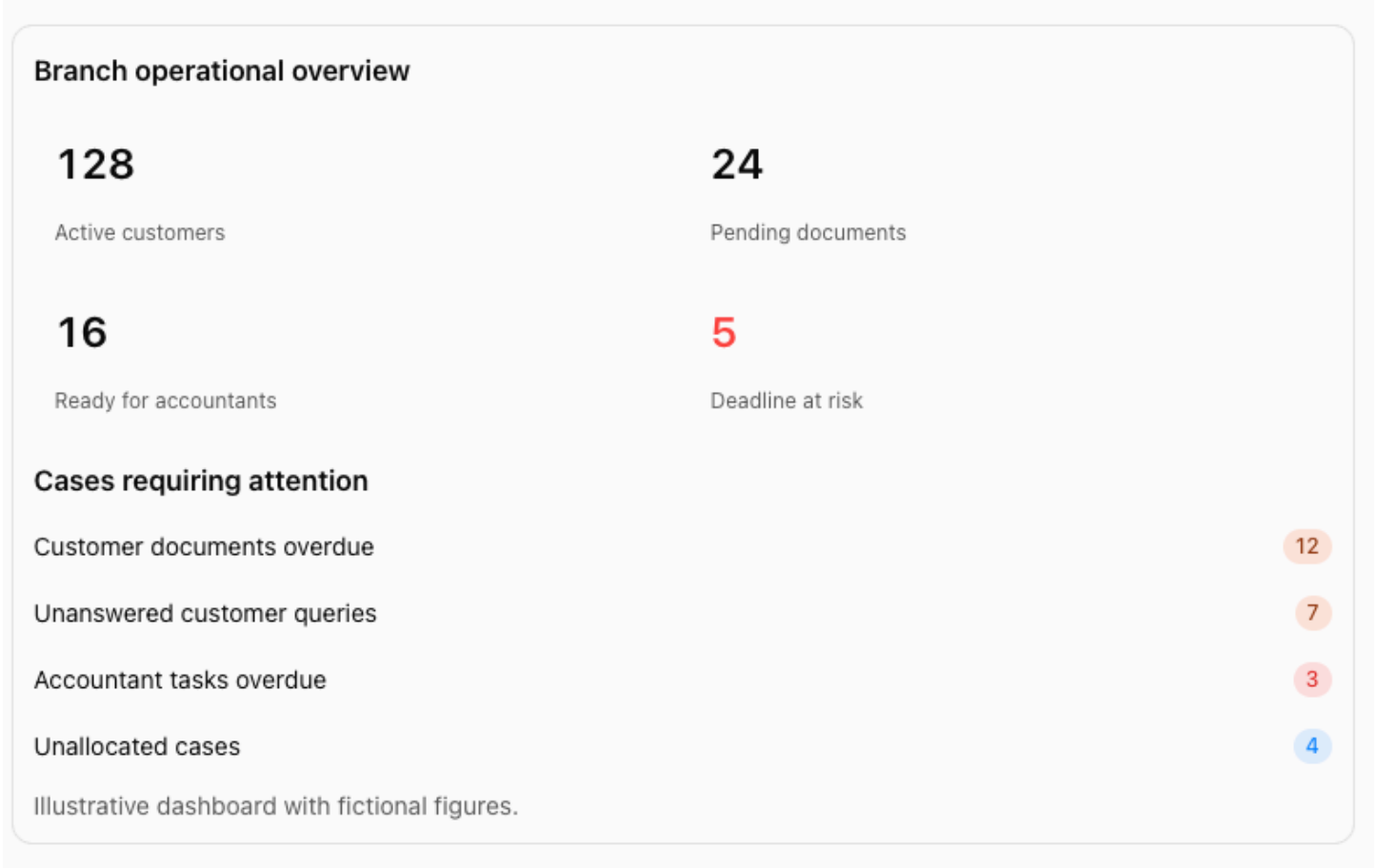
KPI	What it tells the manager
New leads	Incoming enquiries
Conversion rate	Leads becoming customers
Pending onboarding	Customers not fully onboarded
Outstanding documents	Customers holding up cases
Outstanding payments	Unpaid invoices
Ready for accountant	Cases awaiting allocation
Work in progress	Active accounting cases
Overdue cases	Cases beyond internal target
Deadline risk	Statutory deadlines at risk
Completed cases	Work successfully closed

Manager's operational view - The manager should be able to see:

- Which customers need attention?
- Which customers are not responding?
- Which accountant has too many cases?
- Which cases are approaching deadlines?
- Which cases have remained idle?
- Which employees have overdue tasks?
- How much revenue is awaiting collection?
- Which customers have completed their onboarding?
- A particularly useful feature is an Exception Dashboard.

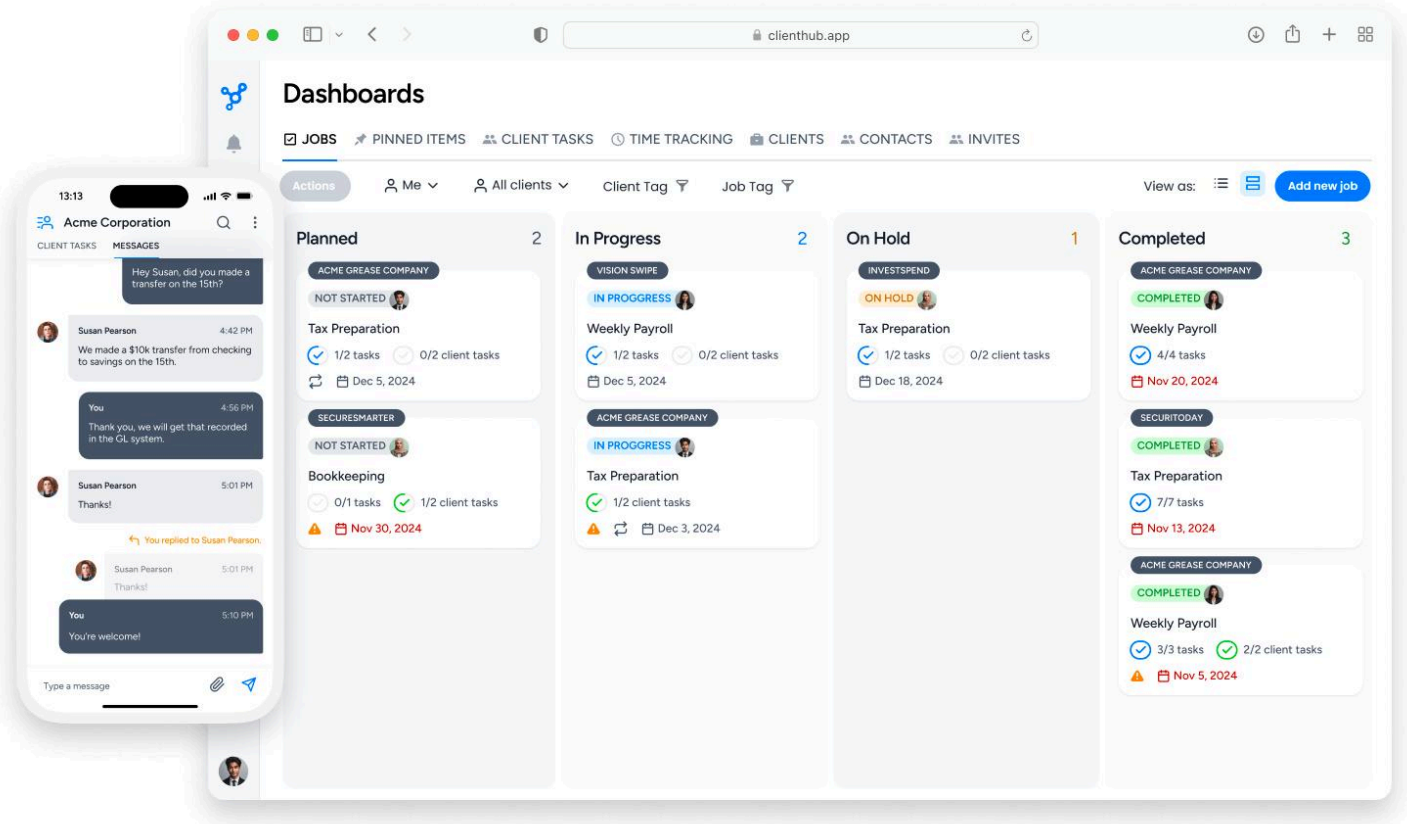
Rather than asking managers to inspect hundreds of cases, show only the cases requiring intervention.

Example:



B. Accountant dashboard

The accountant should have a simple working environment.



Main sections:

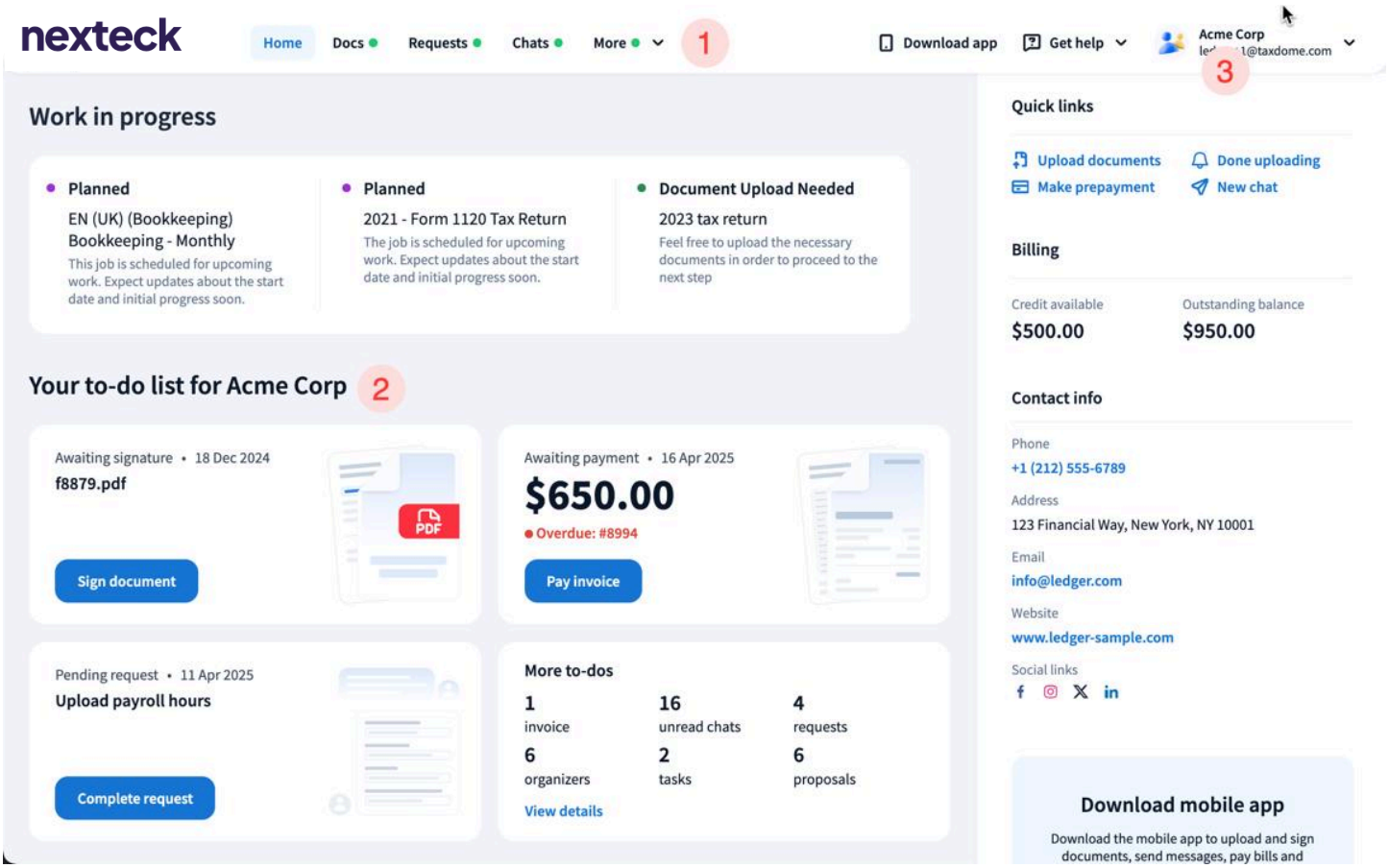
1. My assigned customers.
2. New cases awaiting acceptance.
3. Cases in progress.
4. Customer information required.
5. Outstanding internal reviews.
6. Upcoming deadlines.
7. Completed work.
8. Customer communication history.
9. Every case should have a direct link to its customer profile.

The accountant should be able to:

- Open the complete case.
- View documents.
- Download a document pack.
- Ask the customer a question.
- Request an additional document.
- Update processing status.
- Record an internal note.
- Set a deadline.
- Send a case for review.
- Record submission/completion details.

The system must not force accountants to leave their existing accounting software.

C. Customer dashboard

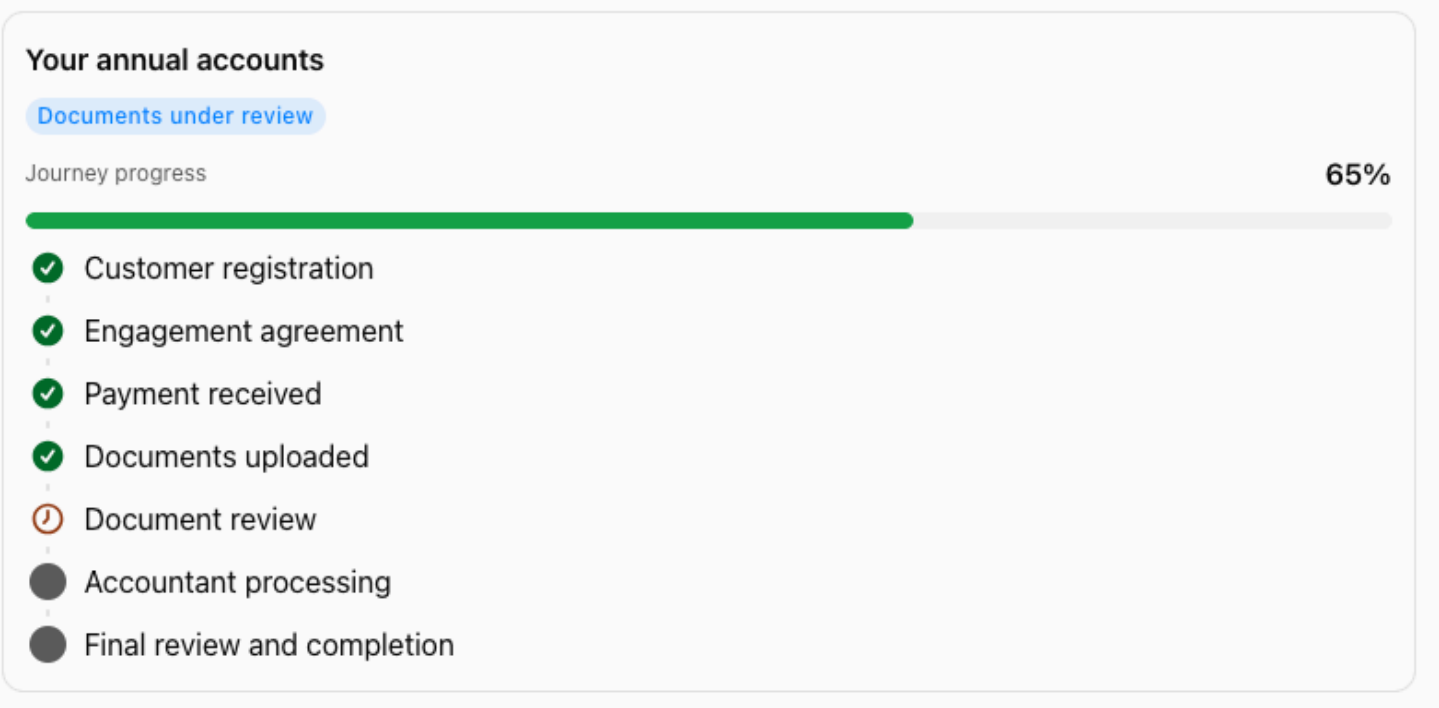


The customer needs a simple experience, particularly customers who are not technically confident.

Main sections:

- My profile.
- My businesses.
- My services.
- Documents required.
- Upload documents.
- Questions from my accountant.
- Outstanding payments.
- Payment history.
- Work progress.
- Messages and notifications.
- Completed services.
- Upcoming deadlines.
- The customer should see a simple progress indicator.

For example:



Progress should be calculated from actual workflow milestones, not simply the number of completed tasks.

D. Sales and customer relationship dashboard

This dashboard should show the commercial pipeline.

- New leads.
- Leads contacted.
- Consultation booked.
- Consultation completed.
- Quotation sent.
- Quotation accepted.
- New customer registration.
- Lost opportunities.
- Follow-up overdue.
- Revenue won.

This allows branch managers to understand how effectively the practice is converting enquiries into customers.

E. Central operations dashboard

- For a multi-branch Account Practice environment, a central dashboard could provide authorised management with:
- Branch-wise onboarding performance.
- Branch-wise service volumes.
- Customer satisfaction.
- Average onboarding time.

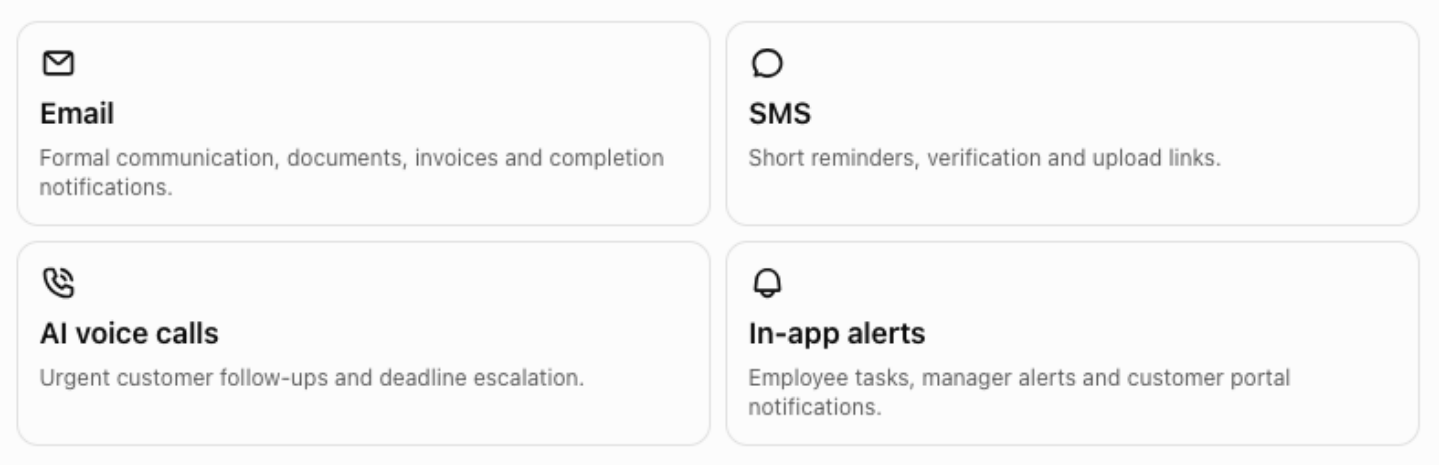
- Outstanding work.
- Deadline risk.
- Notification effectiveness.
- Employee workload.
- Revenue and payment status.
- Branch performance comparisons.

- Access must be permission-based. One branch must not see another branch's confidential customer records without appropriate authorisation.

6. **Intelligent notification engine**

I would build notifications as a separate central module rather than writing notification logic independently inside every workflow.

It should support four channels:



Notification rules

Event	Customer	Accountant	Manager
New enquiry	Acknowledgement	notification	Sales Optional
Quotation sent	Email		
Quotation accepted	Confirmation	Notification	
AML information missing	Reminder	Compliance alert	If overdue
Engagement signed	Confirmation	Notification	
Payment received	Receipt	Notification	
Document missing	Email/SMS	Case update	If critical
Customer query received	Confirmation	Alert	
Case allocated		Email/in-app	Optional
Internal deadline risk		Urgent alert	Escalation
Customer deadline risk	Email/call	Urgent alert	Escalation
Work completed	Completion email	Confirmation	Dashboard update

Notification engine logic

Every notification should have:

- Trigger event.
- Recipient.
- Channel.
- Approved template.
- Sending rules.
- Retry rules.
- Escalation rules.
- Delivery status.
- Response tracking.
- Audit history.
- The system should avoid sending duplicate reminders when a customer has already uploaded a document or responded.

It should also respect communication preferences, consent and applicable marketing/privacy rules. Service notifications and marketing campaigns must be treated separately.

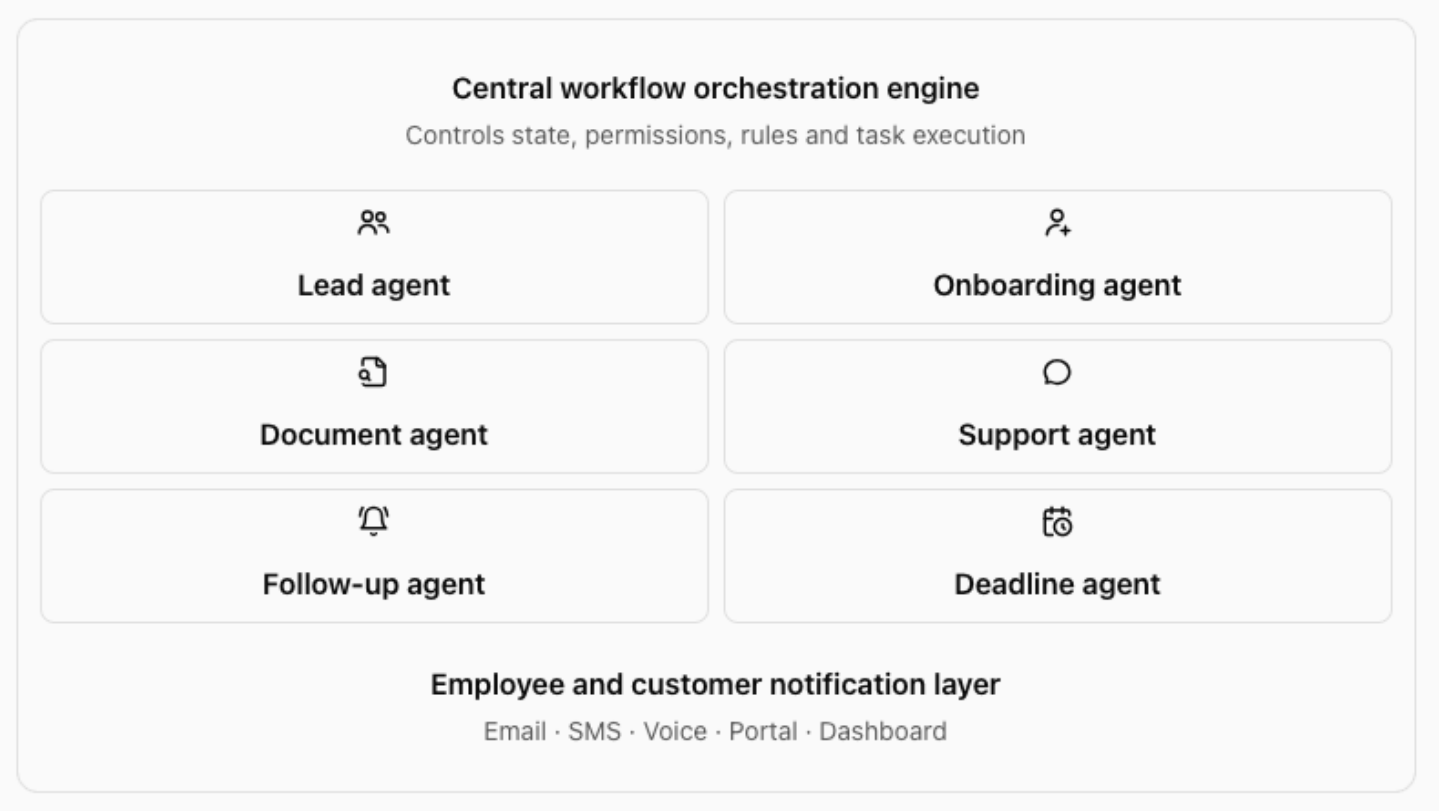
The AI automation layer

This is where the product becomes more valuable than a traditional CRM.

I recommend building six specialised AI capabilities.

AI agent	Responsibility
Lead Agent	Understand enquiries and classify potential customers
Onboarding Agent	Guide customers through registration and service setup
Document Agent	Classify, extract and validate uploaded documents
Customer Support Agent	Answer approved procedural questions
Follow-up Agent	Manage reminders and customer communication
Deadline Monitoring Agent	Identify overdue tasks and deadline risks

How the agents work together



My architectural recommendation: Do not let six independent AI agents control the workflow themselves. Use a deterministic workflow engine as the authority. AI agents should interpret information, classify documents, draft messages and recommend actions. The workflow engine decides whether an action is permitted and records its execution.

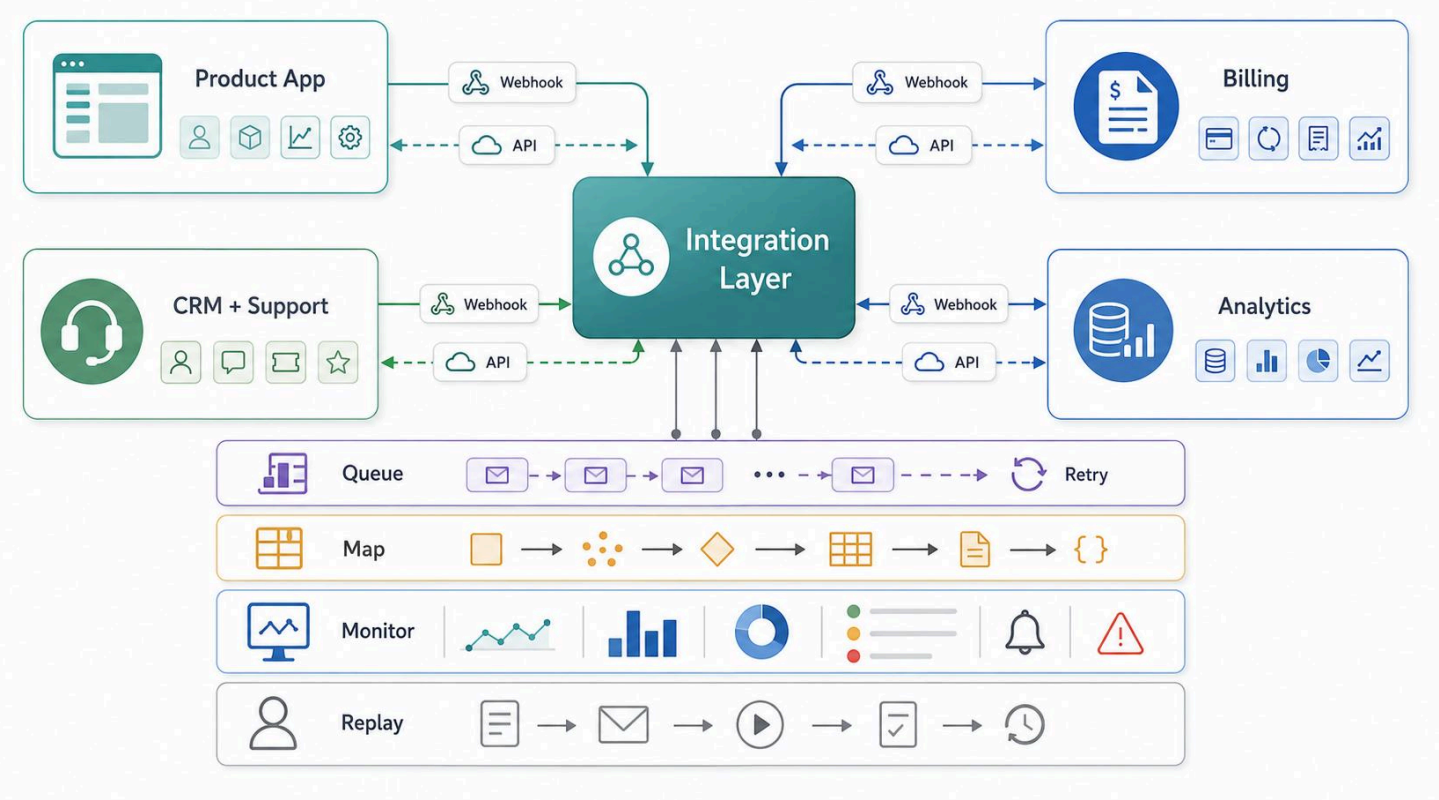
This will make the system auditable and reliable.

Technical architecture and integrations

Account Practice publicly describes an existing technology suite covering onboarding, practice management, tax and accounts compliance, data capture and digital bookkeeping, including use of automation tools such as Dext.

Account Practice Accountants

Therefore, our product must integrate with the existing environment rather than attempt to replace it.



Recommended architecture

Component	Responsibility
Web application	Employee and manager portal
Customer portal	Onboarding and document upload
CRM module	Lead and customer management
Workflow engine	State management and automation
Document management	Secure file storage
AI services	OCR, classification and customer assistance
Notification service	Email, SMS and voice
Payment gateway	Invoice payment and webhook updates
Integration layer	APIs and third-party systems
Analytics	Operational reporting
Audit service	Complete activity history

Third-party integrations

Integration	Suggested purpose
Existing CRM	Customer and lead synchronisation
Existing practice management	Case and work synchronisation
Xero / QuickBooks	Where used by the practice
Dext	Document capture integration, where supported
HMRC services	Approved integrations where available
Companies House	Company information and verification support
Identity verification provider	AML/KYC checks
Stripe or approved payment provider	Online payment
Microsoft 365	Email and calendar
Twilio or equivalent	SMS and voice
E-signature provider	Engagement acceptance
Secure cloud storage	Customer document storage

These are candidate integrations, not assumptions that Account Practice currently uses every product or that every system exposes the required APIs.

A mandatory discovery exercise: Obtain the actual software inventory, API documentation, licensing constraints and integration permissions from the participating Account Practice practice or central technology team.

Data model – what we need to develop

I would design the database around these core entities.

Entity	Purpose
Branch	Account Practice office
Employee	Accountant, manager, sales and admin
Customer	Individual or organisation
Business	Customer's business entity
Lead	Sales enquiry
Service	Service catalogue
Customer Service	Agreed service relationship
Engagement	Engagement letter and terms
AML Case	CDD and risk assessment references
Invoice	Payment request
Payment	Transaction record
Job/Case	Actual accounting work request
Document Requirement	Required document definition
Uploaded Document	Customer file and metadata
Query	Clarification and information request
Task	Employee or customer action
Deadline	Internal or statutory date
Notification	Communication record
Call Record	Voice call details and outcome
Review	Quality review and approval

Audit Log	Record of all important changes

Critical relationship

One customer may have:

- Multiple businesses.
- Multiple engagements.
- Multiple accounting services.
- Multiple financial periods.
- Multiple jobs.
- Multiple invoices.
- Multiple document sets.
- A separate job must exist for each service and accounting period.

For example:

Customer: ABC Trading Ltd

- Job 1: Annual accounts 2025/26.
- Job 2: Corporation Tax 2025/26.
- Job 3: VAT return Q3.
- Job 4: Payroll November 2026.
- These jobs may share customer information, but they have different document requirements, deadlines and accountant allocations.

Security, compliance and audit controls

Because this platform handles sensitive financial and identity information, security cannot be an afterthought.

I recommend:

1. Role-based access control.
2. Branch-level data segregation.
3. Multi-factor authentication for employees.
4. Secure customer authentication.
5. Encryption in transit and at rest.
6. Secure, time-limited document links.
7. Virus and malware scanning.
8. Document version history.
9. Immutable audit events for critical actions.
10. Controlled data exports and downloads.

11. Configurable retention and deletion policies.
12. Data-processing agreements with third-party providers.
13. Incident management and access monitoring.
14. UK GDPR and Data Protection Act compliance.
15. AML records must be retained in accordance with applicable statutory requirements. HMRC's guidance includes a five-year retention period for relevant CDD records after the business relationship ends, subject to the applicable rules.
16. GOV.UK+1

The platform should also have an auditable record of:

- Who approved a document.
- Who waived a document requirement.
- Who authorised a payment exception.
- Who approved AML.
- Who changed a deadline.
- Who closed a case.
- Which automated notification was sent.
- Whether a customer responded.
- AI must never silently change an accounting deadline, compliance status or approved financial record.

Recommended development phases

I would not develop every feature simultaneously. We should build the product in phases, starting with the features that eliminate the most manual work.

Phase 1 – Core customer operations

Highest priority

MVP

- Lead capture and CRM.
- Customer registration.
- Customer and business profiles.
- Service catalogue.
- Engagement letter and e-signature.
- Invoice and payment integration.
- Dynamic document checklist.
- Secure document upload.
- Basic document classification.
- Customer portal.
- Accountant work queue.
- Email notifications.
- Branch dashboard.

Phase 2 – Intelligent automation

- AI document classification and OCR.
- Missing-document detection.
- Customer clarification assistant.
- Automated email and SMS reminders.
- Query management.
- Employee workload allocation.
- Deadline monitoring.
- Escalation management.
- Manager exception dashboard.

Phase 3 – Advanced AI and voice

- AI telephone calling.
- Customer response handling.
- AI customer support.
- Intelligent lead qualification.
- Automated quotation preparation.
- AI case summaries.
- Advanced deadline risk prediction.
- Customer satisfaction automation.

Phase 4 – Multi-branch enterprise platform

- Multiple branch management.
- Central management dashboard.
- Centralised service templates.
- Branch-specific workflow configuration.
- Advanced analytics.
- Franchise-wide reporting.
- Integration with existing practice systems.
- Performance benchmarking.

These are planning estimates, not committed delivery dates.

Phase	Indicative duration
Discovery and requirements	2 weeks
MVP development	8–10 weeks
Intelligent automation	4–6 weeks
Voice AI and advanced features	3–4 weeks
Multi-branch pilot and hardening	3–4 weeks

Some phases can overlap once the integration architecture is agreed.

What should we measure? (Business ROI)

The product should be sold on operational savings and customer experience, not simply the number of AI agents.

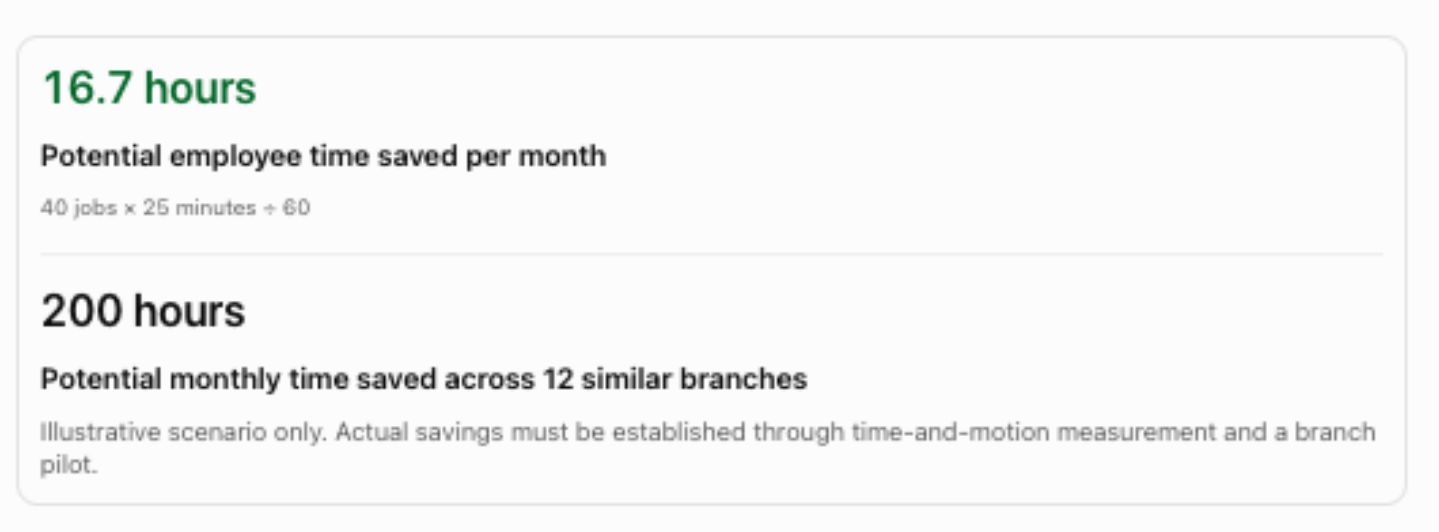
I recommend tracking these metrics:

KPI	What we want to improve
Lead response time	Reduce waiting
Lead conversion	Increase new customers
Onboarding completion time	Faster onboarding
Documents collected digitally	Reduce manual collection
Manual reminder count	Reduce employee effort
Customer query response time	Faster resolution
Payment collection time	Improve cash flow
Accountant preparation time	Reduce administration
Cases overdue	Reduce operational risk
Deadline compliance	Improve reliability
Customer satisfaction	Improve retention

Example ROI model

Let's consider an illustrative branch with:

- 200 active customers.
- 40 new service jobs per month.
- 10 minutes spent on each routine document reminder.
- 15 minutes spent on each document-upload administration task.
- 10 minutes spent on routine customer follow-ups.
- Suppose automation saves 25 minutes per job across 40 jobs.



The real benefit will come from reducing repetitive administrative activity, avoiding missed follow-ups and allowing employees to handle more customers without proportionally increasing headcount.

Additional features I strongly recommend

There are five opportunities worth including in the product roadmap.

1. Customer inactivity prediction: AI identifies customers who are likely to delay providing information based on outstanding tasks and previous interactions.

The system escalates early rather than waiting until the deadline is close.

2. Intelligent document reuse: If a customer has already provided a valid document or information that remains relevant, the platform can reuse it subject to permission, period relevance and verification requirements.
3. Automated customer communication history: All emails, SMS, calls, portal messages and employee notes should appear in one chronological customer timeline.
4. Branch workload balancing: If one accountant has 40 pending cases and another has 12, the manager can see the imbalance and reallocate work based on skills and capacity.
5. Automated recurring customer retention: After completing annual accounts, the system can automatically initiate the next annual service cycle, remind the customer about recurring services and identify opportunities for additional services.

These features create value beyond basic onboarding automation.

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